
II. Network Security-Related Issues

Source:

“New Threats, New Solutions: Enterprise Endpoint Security”

available at

download.zonelabs.com/bin/media/pdf/Hurwitz_wp.pdf

In the rapidly evolving world of network security, there's a thin line between paranoia and prudent protection. Hackers are growing in both number and sophistication, and the stakes are rising every day. New technologies have triggered a shift in the network security paradigm, expanding vulnerability exponentially.

Distributed personal firewalls are needed to protect corporate networks from Internet-enabled espionage, sabotage, and vandalism. Each individual PC—local and remote—must employ security technology to prevent known and unknown attacks. Real-world security needs to be flexible and make intelligent use of Policy Lifecycle Management to balance protection with productivity.

Enterprise Networks At Risk

As networks become larger, more complex, and more distributed, corporations face a growing vulnerability to hacker attacks and industrial espionage. Security consciousness and security spending are both on the increase, but not at a sufficient pace to stay ahead of the growing threat. The DefCon Internet Security site estimated that in 2002, approximately 19 million people had the skills to mount a cyber attack. According to a CSI/FBI survey, a new generation of profit-motivated hackers raised the stakes for corporate security managers. They used Trojan horses such as Back Orifice, Sub7, and other custom spyware to control remote machines, steal passwords, and compromise corporate networks. Hackers randomly scan for vulnerabilities and deploy viruses to harvest IP addresses and information.

Once inside, hackers can conduct espionage or sabotage, steal financial information, disrupt business, and cause public embarrassment. Even networks with VPN tunnels are at risk. The VPN will secure the data in transit, but leaves the endpoints vulnera-